

8. Consolidate conversational skills while studying the character units; consolidate character skills while studying the conversational units.
9. As much as possible, learn language in context rather than from lists. (But be mindful that lists can help with recall and review.)
10. Know the core, test the core (i.e., that practiced in class). For character material, test comprehension.

使用《汉语基础教材》的十个基本原则

- 一、 强调课前预习，课中练习以及课后复习。
- 二、 从简单到复杂，从陌生到熟悉，从机械操练到自然交际。
- 三、 先熟记典型的会话，再向个性化延伸，最后扩展为完整的会话。
- 四、 汉语表达同英语一样复杂多变，学生可将本教材作为用法指南使用，不仅应该听取老师的建议，自己也应勤于观察。
- 五、 与其只学习个别生词，不如学习如何使用词组，借助提示，摹拟实际交流情境，演练与之相匹配的表达方式。
- 六、 分清识字和阅读的不同，阅读活动最好以理解为主。
- 七、 通过书写汉字来提高辨认字形的能力，同时借助拼音输入软件来写作。
- 八、 学习汉字时，同时加强会话能力；学习会话时，同时加强汉字能力，互相促进。
- 九、 与其利用生字表、生词表学习，不如利用有上下文的课文学习。(生字表、生词表可用来回忆与复习。)
- 十、 掌握核心教材，测试核心教材。所谓核心教材指的是课堂教学中所使用的教材，至于汉字教材则主要用来测试理解能力。

Qīng (Manchu) dynasty (1644–1911)

Míng (Han) dynasty (1368–1644)

Yuán (Mongol) dynasty (1271–1368)

1842

1912

1949

Máo Zédōng

Chiang Kai-shek (*Jiǎng Jièshí*)

Sun Yat-sen (*Sūn Yìxiān*)

Chinese

Guānhuà (officials' language)

Mandarin

Guóyǔ (national language)

Pǔtōnghuà (ordinary language)

Standard Chinese

Classical Chinese (*Wényán*)

Báihuà (vernacular written Chinese)

Táiyǔ (Taiwanese Minnan)

Taiwanese Mandarin

Hànyǔ Pīnyīn

Wade-Giles

Zhùyīn Fúhào (*Bopo mofo*)

lingua franca

dialects

regional languages

Cantonese

Fujianese (Hokkien)

Kejia (Hakka)

Shanghainese

recent years, some schools in China have been encouraging children at certain stages in their education to write essays in pinyin to improve composition and style, and it is not unlikely that its functions will continue to expand in the future.

It is sometimes claimed that pinyin (or any other such system of transcribing the sounds of Mandarin) cannot serve as a full-fledged writing system because the degree of homophony in Chinese is such that some reference to characters is necessary for disambiguation. This is certainly true in the case of the *shi* story cited earlier, and it might be true for Classical Chinese in general. However, it is certainly not true for texts written in colloquial styles. *Anything that can be understood in speech can be written and understood in pinyin.* Many people e-mail successfully in pinyin without even indicating the tones! The question is, using pinyin, how far one can stray from colloquial speech and still be understood. Written styles range from the relatively colloquial to the relatively classical, but if the latter can be understood when read aloud, then they can presumably be understood when written in pinyin.

百花齐放，百家争鸣

百花齊放，百家爭鳴

Bǎihuā qífàng, bǎijiā zhēngmíng!

‘Let a hundred flowers blossom and a hundred schools of thought contend!’

(‘100-flowers together-blossom, 100-schools [of thought] contend’)

Key Terms

Peoples Republic of China (PRC)

The Mainland

The Republic of China (ROC)

Taiwan

Hong Kong (*Xiāng Gǎng*)

Běijīng (Peking)

Běipíng (Peiping)